



The Common Application

Equity College Counselling Program–2022

*Presented by Faith Maritim and
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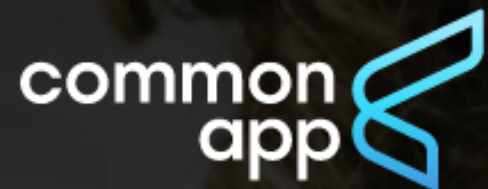


THE COMMON APP?



The Common Application (informally known as the Common App) is an undergraduate college admission application that applicants may use to apply to any of more than 950 member colleges and universities in all 50 states and the District of Columbia, as well as in Canada, China, Japan, and many European countries.[1][2]

NB: Some schools also make use of independent application platforms eg. MIT, state universities



FIND A COLLEGE

Plan for college ▾

Apply to college ▾

Support your students ▾



Sign in

Create an account

Your future starts here

Apply to college for the first time or transfer to complete your degree. Navigate your entire college application journey with Common App.

Start your application

Let's get started!

Welcome to Common App! Please tell us how you will use the system so we can prepare your account. If you are unsure, we encourage you to explore each option before you continue.

Already have an account? [Go to the login page.](#)

First year student



Transfer student



Education professional



Parent or other adult



Let's get started!

Select 'First Year Student' to create your account'

Required Information:

- Email address
- A password (memorable but secure)
- Your full name
- Date of Birth
- Physical Address

PS: Use an active postal address where they can mail your documents. The Equity Head Office Address is highly recommended!

Parts of the Common

App:

- Profile
- Family
- Education
- Testing
- Activities
- Writing
- Courses and Grades*

*Very few schools have this requirement
eg. Stanford University

The screenshot displays the Common App user interface. At the top, there is a navigation bar with five tabs: 'Dashboard', 'My Colleges', 'Common App' (which is the active tab), 'College Search', and 'Financial Aid Resources'. Below this, on the left side, is a sidebar menu titled 'Common App' with several options, each preceded by a green checkmark: 'Profile', 'Family', 'Education', 'Testing', 'Activities', and 'Writing'. Below these options, it says 'Courses & Grades' and '0 college(s) require'. The main content area on the right is titled 'Profile' and features a blue header for 'Personal Information'. Under this header, there are three text input fields. The first field is labeled 'First/given name*' and contains the text 'Faith'. The second field is labeled 'Middle name' and is currently empty. The third field is labeled 'Last/family/surname*' and contains the text 'Maritim'.

PROFILE:

**1. Personal
information**

2. Address

3. Contact details

4. Demographics

5. Language:

- Quote English as a First Language

**6. Geography
and nationality:**

- Applying for an F1 visa

7. Fee Waiver:

- Request at least a month before the submission deadline
- Have an official letter demonstrating need

TIP: Save information in each section before you proceed to avoid losing it

FAMILY

Parent details

- Marital status-self and parents
- Household
- Citizenship
- Employment status
- Education level

Sibling details

- Number of siblings-allows up to 5
- Name
- Age
- Relationship
- Employment over the years
- Education level

TIP: Provide accurate, consistent information in all your applications

EDUCATION

High School Information

- If you have attended more than one high school, explain why
- State that you will take a gap year, and explain how you plan to spend it.
- Also state that you graduated late.
- Leave out your enrollment in a Kenyan university

Honors

- Highest academic achievements

Community organizations

- ELP Advisor:
Beverly+Mentor

Future plans

- Postgraduate +

Grades:

✓ Writing

Courses & Grades
0 college(s) require

Grades

▽

Graduating class size (approx.)*

339

Class rank reporting

☒ Exact

☐ Decile

☐ Quintile

☐ Quartile

☐ None

Clear answer

Class rank*

5

Rank weighting*

☐ Weighted

☒ Unweighted

Clear answer

- Class size, class rank
- Exact reporting, actual scores
- Unweighted GPA

Current or Most Recent Year Courses

- Report the number of subjects you took in high school
- Course level- Regular/Standard
- Course schedule- Full year
- Kiswahili is a **Foreign Language**
- Technical subjects- **Others/Elective**

How many courses would you like to report?*

 X ▾

Please select the course scheduling system your institution is using.*

☐ Semester

☒ Trimester

☐ Quarter

☐ Yearly

Clear answer

Course 1 subject*

 X ▾

Course 1 name*

Course 1 level*

 X ▾

Course 1 schedule*

 X ▾

TESTING

- Most schools are test optional
- Self report tests, scores and score dates
- You can super-score
- KCSE/Senior leaving exams

✓ Family

✓ Education

Testing

✓ Activities

✓ Writing

Courses & Grades
0 college(s) require

Tests Taken

In addition to sending official score reports as required by colleges, do you wish to self-report scores or future test dates for any of the following standardized tests: ACT, SAT/SAT Subject, AP, IB, Cambridge, TOEFL, PTE Academic, IELTS, and Duolingo English Test?*

☒ Yes

☐ No

Clear answer

Indicate all tests you wish to report. Be sure to include tests you expect to take in addition to tests you have already taken.*

SAT Tests X X ▼

International applicants: Is promotion within your educational system based upon standard leaving examinations given at the end of lower and/or senior secondary school by a state or national leaving examinations board? (Students studying in the US typically answer no to this question.)

☒ Yes

☐ No

Clear answer

Continue

ACTIVITIES LIST

Activity 1

Activity type*

- Choose an option -

Position/Leadership description

(Max characters: 50)*

Organization Name

(Max characters: 100)

Please describe this activity, including what you accomplished and any recognition you received, etc.

(Max characters: 150)*

- Clubs, sports, community organizations (10 maximum)
- Leadership positions
- Describe activity, quantify the impact
- Quote the lessons learnt
- Each activity has a limited space; provide accurate and brief descriptions
- Use short forms eg. no., add'l, ID,
- Separate points using semi-colons

ACTIVITIES

Participation grade levels*

- ☐ 9
- ☐ 10
- ☐ 11
- ☐ 12
- ☐ Post-graduate

Timing of participation*

- ☐ During school year
- ☐ During school break
- ☐ All year

Hours spent per week*

Weeks spent per year*

I intend to participate in a similar activity in college.*

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Clear answer

- Record the time spent on each activity, and your interest in participating in this activity in future

WRITING

The Personal Statement

Personal Essay

Some colleges require submission of the personal essay with your Common Application. You may submit a personal essay to any college, even if it is not required by that college. If not required by a college, you will be given the option during submission to include your essay or not for that college.*

☒ I understand

Here is the current list of colleges on your Dashboard and whether they require the Personal Essay.

Required

- Agnes Scott College
- Pepperdine University

Not Required

- George Mason University
- The University of Virginia's College at Wise

- Also known as the Common App Essay
- 650-word limit

Disciplinary information

- Be discreet with petty punishments

Courses and Grades

- Many schools do not require you to fill this section

Additional information

- e.g additional siblings, circumstances

Additional Information 

Community disruptions such as COVID-19 and natural disasters can have deep and long-lasting impacts. If you need it, this space is yours to describe those impacts. Colleges care about the effects on your health and well-being, safety, family circumstances, future plans, and education, including access to reliable technology and quiet study spaces. For more information, check out our [COVID-19 FAQ](#).

Do you wish to share anything on this topic?*

☒ Yes

☐ No

Clear answer

Please use this space to describe how these events have impacted you.*

B *I* U  

Min: 1 / Max: 250 0/250 words

COLLEGE SEARCH

Dashboard

My Colleges

Common App

College Search

Financial Aid Resources

College Search

Application Requirements

College or City Name

Separate multiple search terms with a comma, e.g.: Washington, Boston

More filters

873 results

Sort by: College Name ▼

+

Adelphi University

Garden City, NY - USA

✓

Agnes Scott College

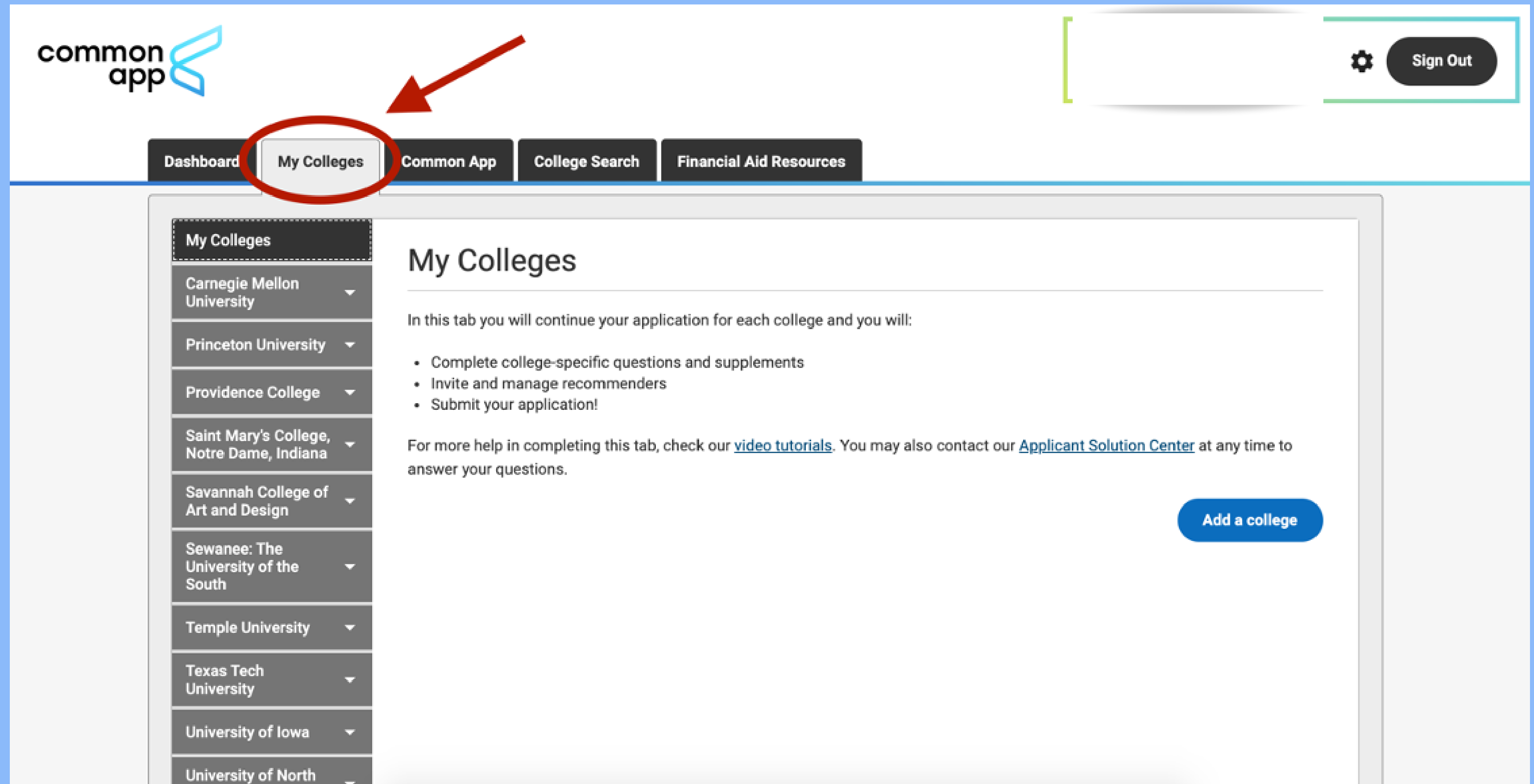
Decatur, GA - USA

+

Alaska Pacific University

Anchorage, AK - USA

MY COLLEGES



common app

Dashboard **My Colleges** Common App College Search Financial Aid Resources

My Colleges

- Carnegie Mellon University
- Princeton University
- Providence College
- Saint Mary's College, Notre Dame, Indiana
- Savannah College of Art and Design
- Sewanee: The University of the South
- Temple University
- Texas Tech University
- University of Iowa
- University of North

My Colleges

In this tab you will continue your application for each college and you will:

- Complete college-specific questions and supplements
- Invite and manage recommenders
- Submit your application!

For more help in completing this tab, check our [video tutorials](#). You may also contact our [Applicant Solution Center](#) at any time to answer your questions.

[Add a college](#)

Sign Out

MY COLLEGES

- Use the **College Search** bar to add colleges into your list
- Check out the Early Action/Early Decision and Regular Decision deadlines, application requirements, etc
- Each school has specific questions and writing supplements (an average of 250 words)

TIP: Boost your chances by writing the optional essays

PS: They're not really 'optional'

My Colleges

Duke University

College Information

Application

Questions

Recommenders and FERPA

Review and Submit - Common App

Writing Supplement

✓ Questions

Review and Submit - Writing Supplement

Trinity University

University of Virginia

Questions

Preview

Writing Questions

The questions on this page are being asked by Duke University

(Optional) Duke University seeks a talented, engaged student body that embodies the wide range of human experience; we believe that the diversity of our students makes our community stronger. If you'd like to share a perspective you bring or experiences you've had to help us understand you better-perhaps related to a community you belong to or your family or cultural background-we encourage you to do so. Real people are reading your application, and we want to do our best to understand and appreciate the real people applying to Duke. (250 word limit) [Duke University Nondiscrimination Statement](#)

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Instructions and Help



Need Help?

If you need assistance answering questions on any of the My Colleges pages, please contact the [Read more](#)

RECOMMENDATIONS AND FERPA

The screenshot shows a web application interface for college recommendations and FERPA. At the top, there are navigation tabs: 'Dashboard', 'My Colleges', 'Common App', 'College Search', and 'Financial Aid Resources'. The 'My Colleges' tab is active, and a sidebar on the left lists various options for 'Duke University' (College Information, Application, Questions, Recommenders and FERPA, Review and Submit - Common App, Writing Supplement, Questions, Review and Submit - Writing Supplement) and other colleges like 'Trinity University' and 'University of Virginia'. The main content area is titled 'Recommendations & FERPA' and includes sections for 'FERPA Release Authorization' (with a 'View Details' link), 'Invite Recommenders' (with a description and a 'video about recommenders' link, and an 'Invite Recommenders' button), 'Counselor' (with a description and an 'Invite Counselor' button), and 'Teacher'. A right-hand sidebar titled 'Instructions and Help' contains three FAQ-style questions with 'Read more' links.

Dashboard **My Colleges** Common App College Search Financial Aid Resources

My Colleges

Duke University ▲

College Information

Application

Questions

Recommendations and FERPA

Review and Submit - Common App

Writing Supplement

✓ Questions

Review and Submit - Writing Supplement

Trinity University ▼

University of Virginia ▼

Recommendations & FERPA

✓ **FERPA Release Authorization**

[View Details](#) ▼

Invite Recommenders

Recommenders are people who will submit forms and information to colleges on your behalf. Check out our [video about recommenders](#).

Invite Recommenders

⚠ Counselor

You must invite a school Counselor who will complete the School Report and other forms for you.

Invite Counselor

⚠ Teacher

Please select a teacher from the Teacher (Mentor) dropdown menu to recommend you to colleges.

Instructions and Help

Who can I list if I do not have a counselor?

If there is no Counselor at your school, you may list your principal or other school official, international [Read more](#)

I'm out of high school. Who do I list if I no longer have a counselor?

Please contact your high school or the local authority that will provide your transcripts. You can enter [Read more](#)

What do I do if I'm an international student and don't have a counselor?

If there is no counselor at your school, the recommendations may be filled out by your principal

RECOMMENDATIONS AND FERPA

The screenshot shows a web application interface for inviting recommenders. A modal window titled "Invite Counselor" is open, displaying a form with the following fields:

- Email Address:** ayden5@cchancesg.com
- Title:** Dr. (selected from a dropdown menu)
- First Name *:** J.J.
- Last Name *:** Thomson

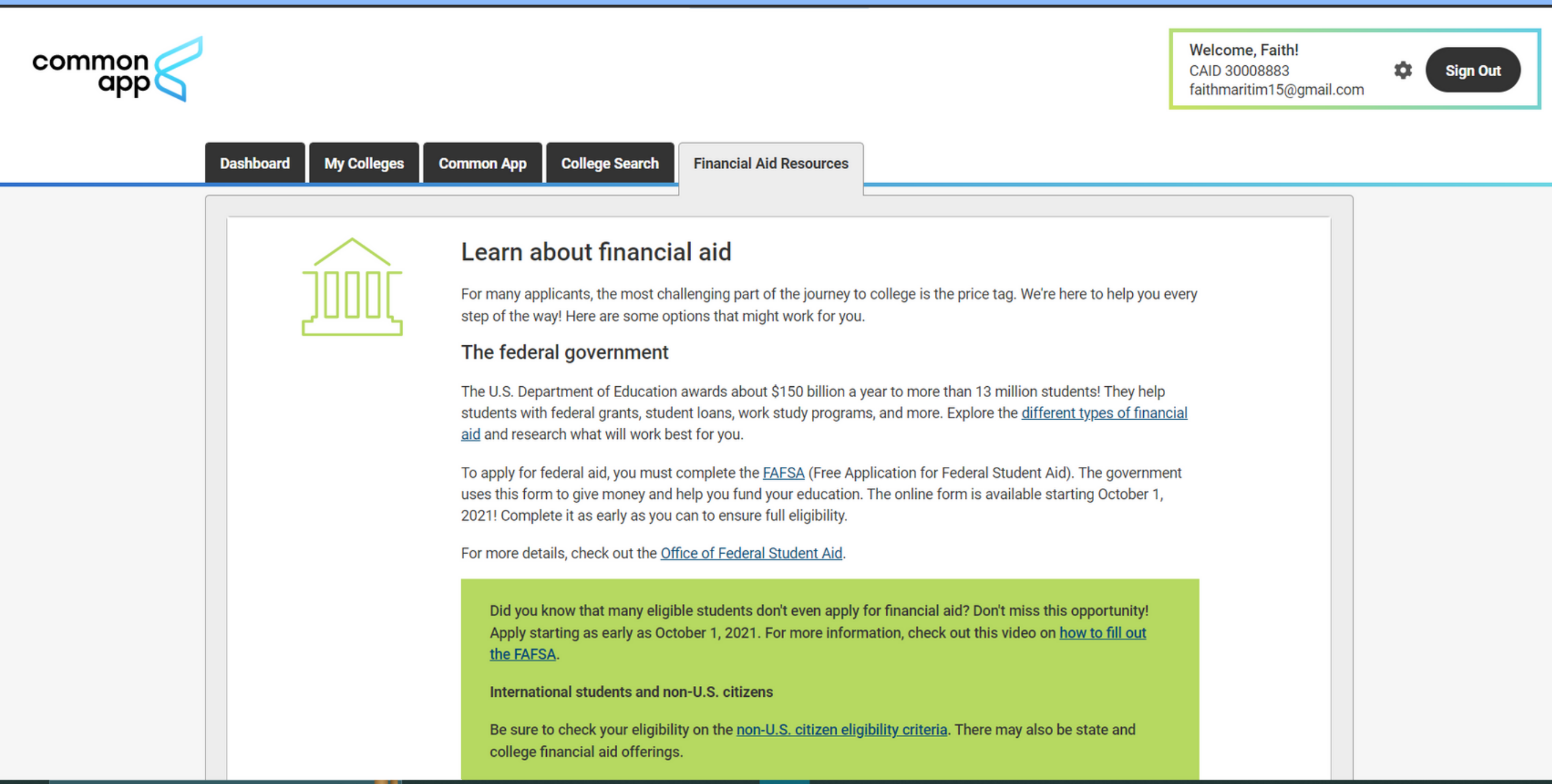
At the bottom of the modal are two buttons: "Cancel" and "Invite".

Numbered red arrows indicate the following steps:

1. Click the "Invite Counselor" button in the background.
2. Click the "Counselor" section header.
3. Click the "First Name" field.
4. Click the "Last Name" field.
5. Click the "Invite" button.

- Waive your right to view recommendations and other application documents
- Get 3 recommendation letters (2 teachers; one from your school counselor)
- Counselor fills in your mid-year report, school profile and final report
- Advisors can view your application
- Add your mentor as your advisor

FINANCIAL AID RESOURCES



The screenshot shows the Common App website's Financial Aid Resources page. At the top left is the Common App logo. At the top right, a user is logged in as 'Faith!' with CAID 30008883 and email faithmaritim15@gmail.com, with a 'Sign Out' button. Below the navigation bar (Dashboard, My Colleges, Common App, College Search, Financial Aid Resources), the main content area is titled 'Learn about financial aid' with a building icon. The text explains that the price tag is a challenging part of college and offers help. It details federal aid from the U.S. Department of Education, mentioning grants, loans, and work study programs. It encourages exploring 'different types of financial aid' and completing the FAFSA (Free Application for Federal Student Aid) starting October 1, 2021. A green box highlights a reminder to apply for financial aid by October 1, 2021, and links to 'how to fill out the FAFSA'. It also mentions international students and non-U.S. citizens, advising them to check eligibility on the 'non-U.S. citizen eligibility criteria' page.

common app

Welcome, Faith!
CAID 30008883
faithmaritim15@gmail.com

Sign Out

Dashboard My Colleges Common App College Search Financial Aid Resources

Learn about financial aid

For many applicants, the most challenging part of the journey to college is the price tag. We're here to help you every step of the way! Here are some options that might work for you.

The federal government

The U.S. Department of Education awards about \$150 billion a year to more than 13 million students! They help students with federal grants, student loans, work study programs, and more. Explore the [different types of financial aid](#) and research what will work best for you.

To apply for federal aid, you must complete the [FAFSA](#) (Free Application for Federal Student Aid). The government uses this form to give money and help you fund your education. The online form is available starting October 1, 2021! Complete it as early as you can to ensure full eligibility.

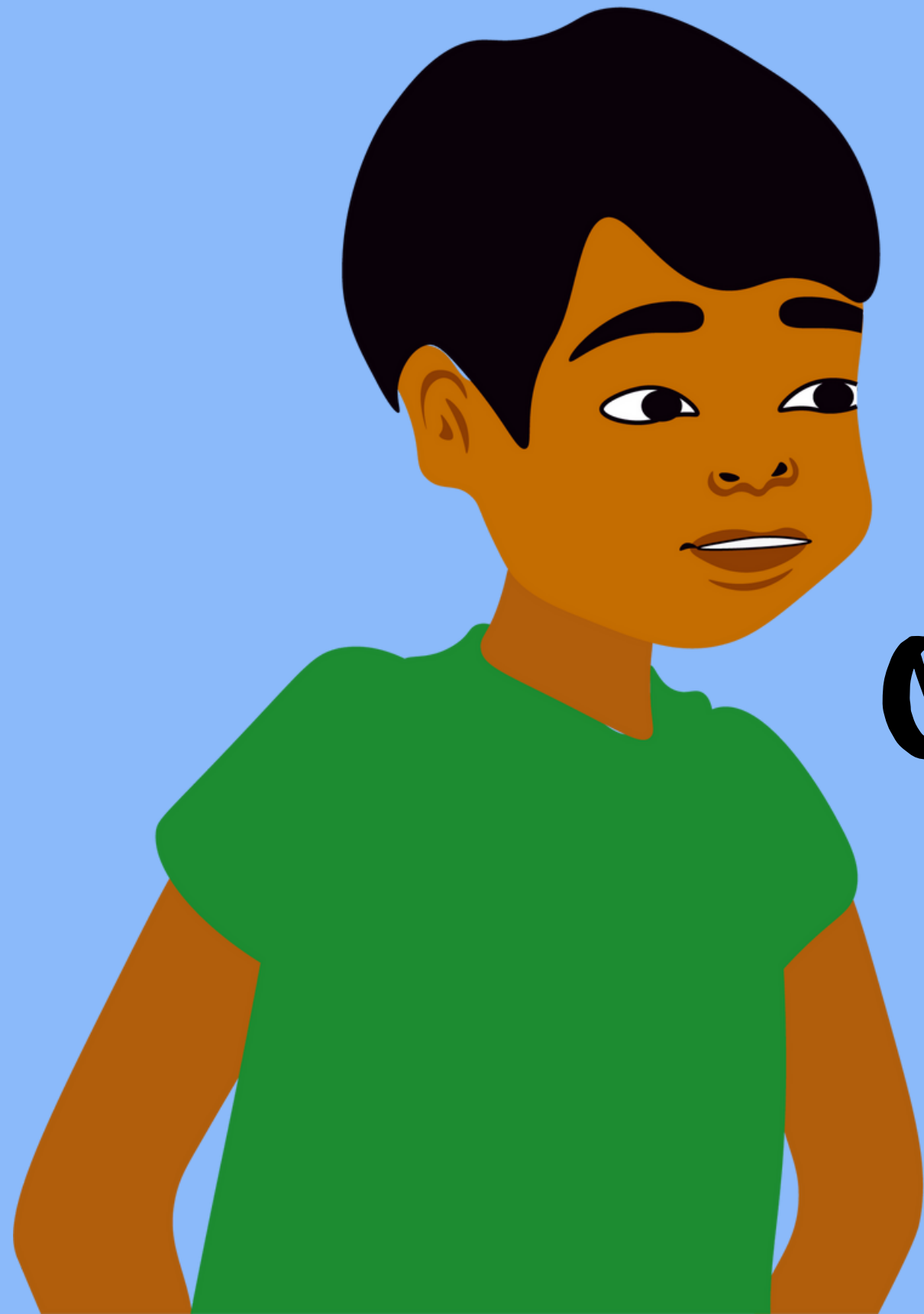
For more details, check out the [Office of Federal Student Aid](#).

Did you know that many eligible students don't even apply for financial aid? Don't miss this opportunity! Apply starting as early as October 1, 2021. For more information, check out this video on [how to fill out the FAFSA](#).

International students and non-U.S. citizens

Be sure to check your eligibility on the [non-U.S. citizen eligibility criteria](#). There may also be state and college financial aid offerings.

- Information on different types of aid
- Shows the financial aid information for schools on your college list
- Information on planning for college costs
- Scholarship opportunities from the **College Board** website



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QUESTIONS?

